and feelings. The soul is immediately known to be present (***svayam prakasha***) in all conscious experiences, whether or not they are of external objects. *Yamuna* understands consciousness as a permanent feature of the soul, which is the unchanging witness of its changing experiences.

In the *Gitarthasamgraha*, he claimed that the ***Bhagavad Gita*** urges us to love God (***bhakti-marga***), which is the way to gain release from the series of births. He understands the supreme goal as a sort of personal relationship with God in heaven.

Further reading: Bartley 2002; Buitenen 1953; Mesquita 1988; Neevel 1977

Yoga: a discipline aiming at salvation by purifying and perfecting the soul through the elimination of distracting thoughts and feelings. This involves both physical and mental self-control. The basic text of the classical Yoga school (***darshana***) is Patanjali's Yoga Sutra (c. 200 BCE–400 CE). The Yoga Sutra defines its subject as the restraint of all mental modifications – that is to say, the suppression of all forms of extroverted thought and feeling (*citta-vritti-nirodha*). Classical Yoga accepts the ***Samkhya*** dualism of primal matter (*prakriti*) and pristine conscious souls (*purusha*) but believes in the existence of God (*Ishvara*) who is a conscious individual unique in that it is never subject to ***karma***. God initiates the world process by connecting conscious subjects with matter.

Souls, entangled in a morass of fluctuating mental and material phenomena, recover their true natures as pure consciousness when mentality (***buddhi***), ego (***ahamkara***) and the faculty coordinating the senses (***manas***) cease. To achieve this the mind–body complex with its passions,